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After the [SpaceX](#) IPO, All Eyes Are on: [OpenAI](#) and [Anthropic](#) IPOs. 🤖

But the real question is not whether these companies deserve trillion-dollar valuations. The answer seems to be two-fold:

- ◆ OpenAI and Anthropic can make intelligence cheap enough to serve at massive scale.
- ◆ They can build the harness around that intelligence that companies rent the entire system instead of building it themselves.

A model is raw intelligence. A harness is what turns that intelligence into useful work. It includes context, skills, commands, memory, tools, files, evaluations, routing logic, permissions, and workflows that define what "done" actually means.

This distinction matters because if intelligence keeps getting cheaper, the value shifts elsewhere (read, harness). History shows that when an input becomes abundant, the most defensible value often moves to what people build around that input. In AI, that "something" is increasingly the harness.

Codex and Claude Code are good examples. Their value does not come only from having smart models underneath. Their value comes from the fact that the models sit inside systems that understand the job. They can access repositories, edit files, run tests, inspect errors, maintain context, and participate in real workflows.

The product is no longer just intelligence. The product is a working agent. 🤖

This also changes how companies should think about AI strategy. The strategic question is not whether to use Model A, Model B, or Model C. The strategic question is whether you are "renting the harness or owning it." Owning the harness does not mean training a custom LLM. Almost no company should do that. It means owning your private context, workflows, permissions, evaluations, review processes, and routing logic. If you own those things, model providers become suppliers. If someone else owns them, they become your BOSS.

The same idea applies to individuals. Prompting is no longer the moat many people think it is. The more valuable skill is harness building: defining recurring work clearly, providing the right context, connecting the

right tools and files, evaluating outputs, and continuously improving the system.

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(Note: the above post is inspired by a recent video by [Nate B. Jones](#). Visual is created using AI with a detailed prompt)

